

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

TRUMP'S IMMIGRATION CRACKDOWN

Madigan's likely last act will be in court

After 6 decades on public stage, ex-House speaker to be sentenced Friday

By Jason Meisner and Ray Long
Chicago Tribune

Michael J. Madigan stepped onto Illinois' public stage as a young man in the late 1960s, when he was elected as one of 118 delegates to the state constitutional convention in Springfield.

"I enjoyed it a great deal because it was like a tutorial on Illinois government and the constitutional organic structure that would support the functioning of the government," Madigan testified in a federal courtroom earlier this year, telling the jury he was so moved by the experience that it motivated him to run for the Illinois House.

Few would have guessed that early immersion would lead one of the most remarkable political careers in the history of the country, with the Democrat Madigan serving a record run as House speaker and widely hailed as the most powerful elected official in the state.

On Friday, six decades after the constitutional convention, Madigan will appear for what likely will be his last public act. And it will play out in a forum that virtually no one — especially a shrewd political tactician such as himself — would have ever seen coming.

The stage will be a federal courtroom on 12th Floor of the Dirksen U.S. Courthouse, where Madigan, 83, is scheduled to be sentenced for his conviction in February on a wide range of corruption charges alleging that he used his public office to increase his power, line his own pockets and enrich a small circle of his most loyal associates.

It's the most highly anticipated sentencing in a Chicago public corruption case since former Democratic Gov. Rod Blagojevich more than a decade ago, and U.S. District Judge John Robert Blakey has a wide range of options at his disposal.

Federal prosecutors have asked for a lengthy 12½-year prison term and a \$1.5 million fine, arguing in a filing earlier this month that the evidence showed "Madigan engaged in corrupt activity at the highest level of state government for nearly a decade.

"Time after time, Madigan exploited his immense power for his own personal benefit by trading his public office for private gain for himself and his associates, all the while carefully and deliberately concealing his conduct from detection," the filing stated.

Madigan's attorneys, meanwhile, are asking for just five

Turn to Madigan, Page 2



Gov. JB Pritzker speaks during a House Committee on Oversight and Government Reform hearing on Thursday in Washington. JULIA DEMAREE NIKHINSON/AP

IN NATION & WORLD: Federal judge issues temporary order halting troop deployment. ■ Mexican flags at anti-deportation protests in Los Angeles are seen as counterproductive.

Pritzker defends sanctuary policies

Governor backs laws, slams Trump's National Guard moves in LA

By Rick Pearson and Daniel C. Vock
Chicago Tribune

WASHINGTON — Democratic Gov. JB Pritzker defended Illinois' sanctuary laws for immigrants in the U.S. without legal permission before a House committee Thursday and pointed at congressional Republicans and Democrats for using the issue to try to score political points rather

than enacting comprehensive immigration reform.

"The vast majority of immigrants contribute to our communities, pay taxes and abide by the law. We should value their entrepreneurship, ingenuity and hard work. Both political parties are to blame for America's broken immigration system. I hope that this committee chooses (to) be part of the solution by pursuing bipartisan comprehensive

federal immigration reform," the state's two-term governor said in remarks submitted to the House Oversight and Government Reform Committee.

"Our border should be secured. The asylum process should be reformed. Law-abiding, hard-working, tax-paying people who have been in this country for years should have a path to citi-

Turn to Hearing, Page 4



EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Protests continue in Chicago

A federal agent exits a black SUV, left, to move an activist blocking the street outside of Chicago Immigration Court at 55 E. Monroe St. on Thursday. Protests continued for another day Thursday in Chicago, part of the demonstrations across the country against President Donald Trump's deployment of troops in Los Angeles amid his immigration crackdown. **Chicagoland, Page 4**

Israel launches attack on Iran's capital

Tensions reach new heights over Tehran's nuclear program

By Jon Gambrell and Josef Federman
Associated Press

JERUSALEM — Israel attacked Iran's capital early Friday, with explosions boom-

ing across Tehran as Israel said it targeted nuclear and military sites.

The attack comes as tensions have reached new heights over Tehran's rapidly advancing nuclear program. The Board of Governors at the International Atomic Energy Agency for the first time in 20 years on Thursday censured Iran over it not working with its inspectors. Iran

immediately announced it would establish a third enrichment site in the country and swap out some centrifuges for more-advanced ones.

Israel for years has warned it will not allow Iran to build a nuclear weapon, something Tehran insists it doesn't want — though officials there have repeatedly warned it could build them. The United States has

been preparing for something to happen, already pulling some diplomats from Iraq's capital this week and offering voluntary evacuations for the families of U.S. troops in the wider Middle East.

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said in an address on YouTube that the attacks will

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Plea deal ends career of officer who struck boy, 14

By Christy Gutowski and Stacy St. Clair
Chicago Tribune

A veteran Chicago police officer will no longer carry a badge as part of a plea agreement in which he admitted that he struck an eighth grade boy while making an off-duty visit to a South Side elementary school two years ago.

Craig Lancaster, 56, was placed on 18 months' supervision and ordered to undergo eight hours of anger management as part of a plea deal in which prosecu-

tors reduced the original felony charge of aggravated battery to misdemeanor disorderly conduct.

Lancaster also agreed to voluntarily decertify as a police officer, ending his nearly 30 years of service to the Chicago Police Department. He was indicted in late 2023 after the Tribune published a video that showed Lancaster striking 14-year-old JaQuwaun Williams near his throat as the boy walked

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Craig Lancaster, a Chicago police officer for nearly 30 years, arrives at the Leighton Criminal Court Building on Thursday. He will no longer carry a badge as part of a plea agreement. ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

INSIDE

Hundreds are dead in India plane crash

An Air India plane bound for London crashed in a residential neighborhood of Ahmedabad shortly after takeoff, killing at least 241 people. **Nation & World**

Using summer as a way to get ahead

As the Bears separate for summer, coach Ben Johnson will stay dialed in — and connected with quarterback Caleb Williams. **Chicago Sports**

TODAY'S WEATHER



High 80 Low 62

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 12

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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